

## WEEK 5

reMarkable Edition

# Week 5 Study Guide

## Bladder & Kidney Channels

BL (67 pts) + KI (27 pts) = 94 Points

### This Week Covers:

- Bladder Meridian of Foot-Taiyang (BL1-BL67) with MOA + CAM figures
- BL 5 Branches — full detailed running course (longest channel in the body)
- BL 14 Crossing Points — the most of any channel
- Kidney Meridian of Foot-Shaoyin (KI1-KI27) with MOA + CAM figures
- KI 3 Branches — full detailed running course, ending at the Pericardium link
- KI 6 Crossing Points — abdomen and chest
- Full Back-Shu Series (BL13-BL28) — organ transport points
- Dr. Zhang's Clinical Pearls — direct from lecture
- BL vs KI Quick Reference — side-by-side comparison

QUIZ 4 (next class) covers: BL & KI channels.

BL & KI are taught this week; PC & SJ will be TAUGHT next week (Week 6).

MOA: BL pp.251-256 | KI pp.331-335

CAM: Col. Fig. 8-9 | Slides: Dr. Vivian Zhang, Week 5

# The Bladder Meridian of Foot-Taiyang

Yang | Water | 3 PM – 5 PM | 67 Points

Pertaining **Bladder**

Connecting **Kidney**

Back-Shu **BL28**

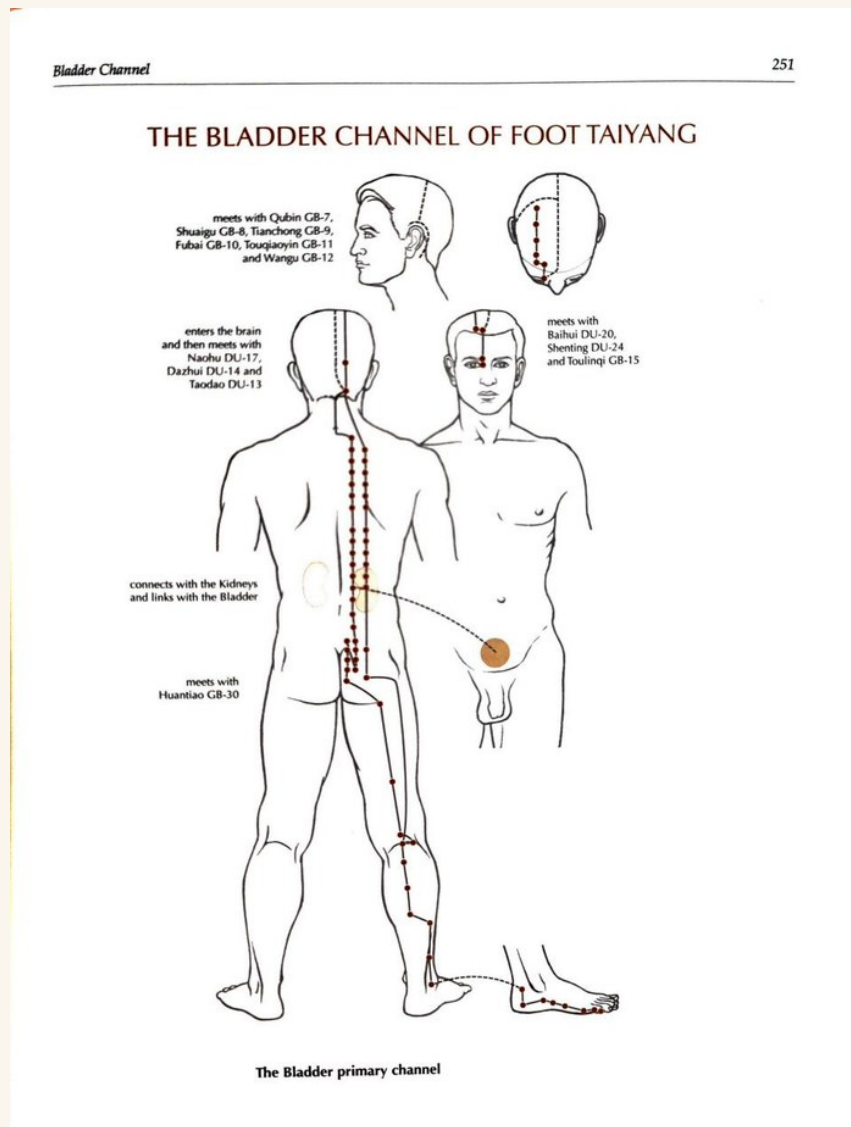
Front-Mu **CV3 Zhongji**

Yuan-Source **BL64**

Luo **BL58**

He-Sea **BL40**

## Internal Running Course



MOA - BL Meridian (internal pathway)

- 1 Starts from the inner canthus (Jingming, BL1), ascends the forehead (BL2 Zanzhu, BL3 Meichong, BL4 Quchai) toward the vertex.
- 2 Continues up the forehead (BL5, BL6, BL7 Tongtian), joining the Governor Vessel at the vertex (Baihui, GV20).
- 3 BRANCH: from the vertex to the temple, crossing GB7, GB8, GB9, GB10, GB11 and GB12 — one of BL's 14 cross-points shared with the GV and GB channels.
- 4 STRAIGHT PORTION: from the vertex, enters and communicates with the brain, emerges and bifurcates at BL10 (Tianzhu) to descend the posterior neck.
- 5 Runs alongside the medial border of the scapula, parallel to the spine (BL11–BL17, alongside GV13/GV14), reaching the lumbar region (BL18–BL23).
- 6 Enters the body cavity, connects with the Kidney, and pertains to its home organ, the Bladder (BL24–BL30).
- 7 BRANCH: from the lumbar region, descends through the gluteal region and ends in the popliteal fossa (BL40 Weizhong).
- 8 BRANCH (largest): from the posterior neck, runs straight down the medial border of the scapula (BL41–BL54), through the gluteal region — meeting GB30 (Huantiao).
- 9 Descends the lateral thigh and meets the branch from Step 7 in the popliteal fossa (BL40), where the two lines merge into one.
- 10 Continues down the posterior leg (BL55, BL56, BL57) to the area behind the external malleolus (BL58, BL59, BL60).
- 11 Runs along the 5th metatarsal bone (BL61–BL64) to the lateral side of the tip of the little toe (BL65, BL66, BL67 Zhiyin).
- 12 LINKS with the Kidney Meridian of Foot-Shaoyin, continuing the Posterior Circuit.

### Functions (MOA)

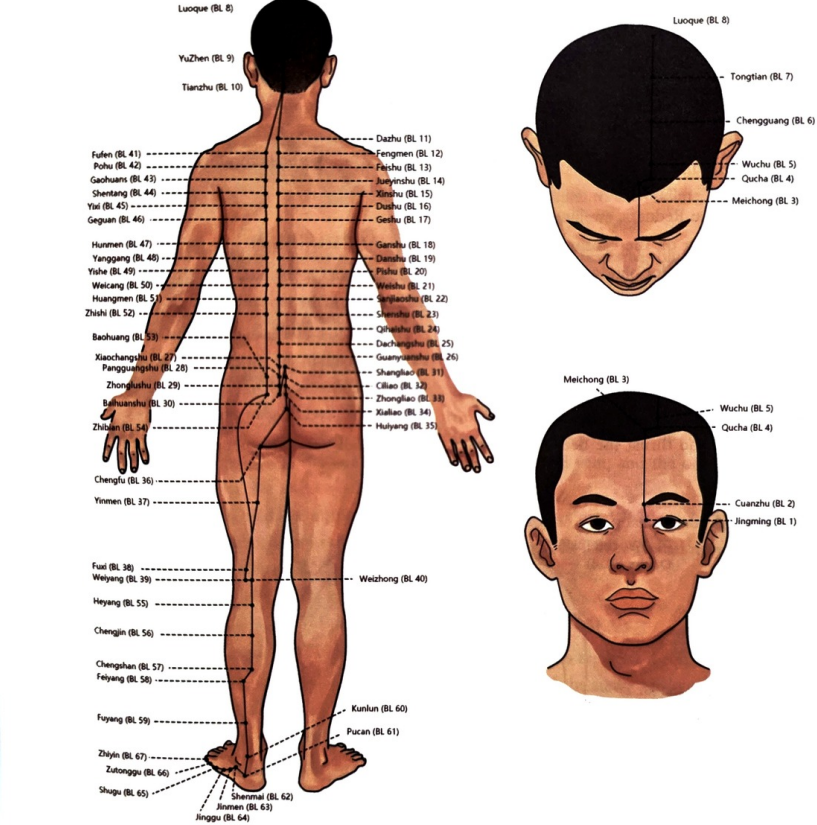
- Governs storage & excretion of urine (Water passageway)
- Longest channel; controls the posterior body surface
- Dominates tendons via the Bladder-Sinew channel
- ONLY channel carrying the full Back-Shu series (BL13–BL28)
- Front-Mu: CV3 Zhongji | Back-Shu: BL28 Pangguangshu

The Bladder Meridian (BL) - External Running Course & CAM Figures

Pertaining Bladder Connecting Kidney Back-Shu BL28

| Pt   | Chinese      | Location & Notes                                                          |
|------|--------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| BL1  | Jingming     | 0.1 cun superior to inner canthus                                         |
| BL2  | Zanzhu       | Depression at medial end of eyebrow                                       |
| BL3  | Meichong     | 0.5 cun within hairline, above BL2                                        |
| BL4  | Quchai       | 0.5 cun within hairline, 1.5 cun lateral to midline                       |
| BL5  | Wuchu        | 1 cun within hairline, 1.5 cun lateral to midline                         |
| BL6  | Chengguang   | 2.5 cun within hairline, 1.5 cun lateral to midline                       |
| BL7  | Tongtian     | 4 cun within hairline, 1.5 cun lateral to midline                         |
| BL8  | Luoque       | 5.5 cun within hairline, 1.5 cun lateral to midline                       |
| BL9  | Yuzhen       | 2.5 cun within hairline, 1.3 cun lateral to midline                       |
| BL10 | Tianzhu      | 1.3 cun lateral to midline, within hairline                               |
| BL11 | Dazhu        | 1.5 cun lat. to lower border T1 spinous process - Influential pt - Bone   |
| BL12 | Fengmen      | 1.5 cun lat. to lower border T2 spinous process                           |
| BL13 | Feishu       | 1.5 cun lat. to lower border T3 spinous process - Back-Shu - Lung         |
| BL14 | Jueyinshu    | 1.5 cun lat. to lower border T4 spinous process - Back-Shu - Pericardium  |
| BL15 | Xinshu       | 1.5 cun lat. to lower border T5 spinous process - Back-Shu - Heart        |
| BL16 | Dushu        | 1.5 cun lat. to lower border T6 spinous process                           |
| BL17 | Geshu        | 1.5 cun lat. to lower border T7 spinous process - Influential pt - Blood  |
| BL18 | Ganshu       | 1.5 cun lat. to lower border T9 spinous process - Back-Shu - Liver        |
| BL19 | Danshu       | 1.5 cun lat. to lower border T10 spinous process - Back-Shu - Gallbladder |
| BL20 | Pishu        | 1.5 cun lat. to lower border T11 spinous process - Back-Shu - Spleen      |
| BL21 | Weishu       | 1.5 cun lat. to lower border T12 spinous process - Back-Shu - Stomach     |
| BL22 | Sanjiaoshu   | 1.5 cun lat. to lower border L1 spinous process - Back-Shu - San Jiao     |
| BL23 | Shenshu      | 1.5 cun lat. to lower border L2 spinous process - Back-Shu - Kidney       |
| BL24 | Qihai        | 1.5 cun lat. to lower border L3 spinous process                           |
| BL25 | Dachangshu   | 1.5 cun lat. to lower border L4 spinous process - Back-Shu - Large Int.   |
| BL26 | Guanyuanshu  | 1.5 cun lat. to lower border L5 spinous process                           |
| BL27 | Xiaochangshu | 1.5 cun lat. to lower border S1 foramen - Back-Shu - Small Int.           |
| BL28 | Pangguangshu | 1.5 cun lat. to lower border S2 foramen - Back-Shu - Bladder              |
| BL29 | Zhonglvshu   | 1.5 cun lat. to lower border S3 foramen                                   |
| BL30 | Baihuanshu   | 1.5 cun lat. to lower border S4 foramen                                   |
| BL31 | Shangliao    | 1st posterior sacral foramen - Ba Liao group                              |
| BL32 | Ciliao       | 2nd posterior sacral foramen - Ba Liao group                              |
| BL33 | Zhongliao    | 3rd posterior sacral foramen - Ba Liao group                              |
| BL34 | Xialiao      | 4th posterior sacral foramen - Ba Liao group                              |
| BL35 | Huiyang      | 0.5 cun lateral to tip of coccyx                                          |
| BL36 | Chengfu      | Midpoint of transverse gluteal fold                                       |
| BL37 | Yinmen       | 6 cun below BL36, on line to BL40                                         |
| BL38 | Fuxi         | 1 cun above BL39, medial to biceps femoris tendon                         |
| BL39 | Weiyang      | Lateral end of popliteal crease - Lower He-Sea of San Jiao                |
| BL40 | Weizhong     | Midpoint of popliteal crease - He-Sea; Command - back                     |
| BL41 | Fufen        | 3 cun lat. to lower border T2 spinous process                             |
| BL42 | Pohu         | 3 cun lat. to lower border T3 spinous process                             |
| BL43 | Gaohuang     | 3 cun lat. to lower border T4 spinous process - All deficiency-taxation   |
| BL44 | Shentang     | 3 cun lat. to lower border T5 spinous process                             |
| BL45 | Yixi         | 3 cun lat. to lower border T6 spinous process                             |
| BL46 | Geguan       | 3 cun lat. to lower border T7 spinous process                             |
| BL47 | Hunmen       | 3 cun lat. to lower border T9 spinous process                             |
| BL48 | Yanggang     | 3 cun lat. to lower border T10 spinous process                            |
| BL49 | Yishe        | 3 cun lat. to lower border T11 spinous process                            |
| BL50 | Weicang      | 3 cun lat. to lower border T12 spinous process                            |
| BL51 | Huangmen     | 3 cun lat. to lower border L1 spinous process                             |
| BL52 | Zhishi       | 3 cun lat. to lower border L2 spinous process                             |
| BL53 | Baohuang     | 3 cun lat. to lower border S2 foramen                                     |
| BL54 | Zhibian      | 3 cun lat. to lower border S3 foramen                                     |
| BL55 | Heyang       | 2 cun below BL40, on line to BL57                                         |
| BL56 | Chengjin     | 5 cun below BL40, top of gastrocnemius                                    |
| BL57 | Chengshan    | 8 cun below BL40, apex of gastrocnemius - Classic for hemorrhoids         |
| BL58 | Feiyang      | 7 cun above BL60, postero-inferior to gastrocnemius - Luo-connecting      |
| BL59 | Fuyang       | 3 cun directly above BL60 - Xi-Cleft of Yang Qiao Mai                     |
| BL60 | Kunlun       | Depression between lat. malleolus & Achilles tendon - Jing-River          |
| BL61 | Pucan        | Below BL60, 4 cun inferior to lateral malleolus                           |
| BL62 | Shenmai      | Depression directly below lateral malleolus - Confluent - Yang Qiao Mai   |
| BL63 | Jinmen       | Anterior-inferior to BL62, lateral foot - Xi-Cleft                        |
| BL64 | Jinggu       | Lateral foot, antero-inferior to 5th MT tuberosity - Yuan-Source          |
| BL65 | Shugu        | Posterior to 5th MT-phalangeal joint - Shu-Stream                         |
| BL66 | Zutonggu     | Anterior to 5th MT-phalangeal joint - Ying-Spring                         |
| BL67 | Zhiyin       | Lateral side of tip of small toe - Jing-Well; last point                  |

Front-Mu CV3 Zhongji Yuan-Source BL64 Luo BL58 He-Sea BL40



CAM Col. Fig. 8 - Bladder Meridian

## BL – Crossing Points (Detailed)

Dr. Zhang: "BL has 14 crossing points – the most of any single channel. Most are located around the head. Any headache/eye/neck symptom – always consider BL channel too."

### GV24 Shenting + GB15 Toulinqi

GV24 / GB15

Location: Forehead / anterior hairline

#### Clinical:

BL's first branch (BL2–BL4) crosses the Governor Vessel and Gallbladder channel here as it ascends the forehead toward the vertex. Used for frontal headache, dizziness, nasal congestion.

### GB7–GB12 (six-point temple group)

GB channel

Location: Temple region, ear to mastoid

#### Clinical:

BL's temple branch (Step 3) crosses all six of these Gallbladder points – Qubin, Shuaigu, Tianchong, Fubai, Touqiaoyin, Wangu. Migraine, temporal headache, tinnitus, TMJ-region pain.

### GV20 Baihui

GV20 / Du Mai

Location: Vertex, midline

#### Clinical:

BL joins the Governor Vessel at the very top of the head. Classic point for headache, dizziness, prolapse (organ/rectal/uterine), and calming the shen.

### GV16 Fengfu + GV17 Naohu

GV16–17 / Du Mai

Location: Nape / occiput, brain region

#### Clinical:

BL's straight portion communicates with the brain and crosses these two Du Mai points before bifurcating at BL10. Occipital headache, stiff neck, dizziness.

### GV13 Taodao + GV14 Dazhui

GV13–14 / Du Mai

Location: Upper back, alongside BL11–BL17

#### Clinical:

BL's back line runs parallel to the spine alongside these Governor Vessel points. Dazhui (GV14) is the meeting point of all Yang channels – fever, neck stiffness, immune support.

### GB30 Huantiao

GB30 / GB channel

Location: Gluteal region

#### Clinical:

BL's largest branch passes directly through this Gallbladder point in the buttock on its way down the posterior thigh. Classic point for sciatica and hip/low-back pain along the pathway.

## BL - Syndromes & High-Yield Points

### A. External Course Symptoms

- Headache (two head branches cross the brain region)
- Stiff neck, rigidity of the spine
- Low back pain, lumbar pain along the running course
- Sciatica-type pain, calf pain, stiff/painful leg
- Eye disorders (redness, pain, blurred vision — near BL1)
- Occipital pain, pain of the scapula and back

### B. Internal Organ (Bladder)

- Difficult or painful urination, retention of urine
- Enuresis, dark or turbid urine
- Bladder-qi dysfunction generally
- Via Back-Shu series: dysfunction of ANY zang-fu organ
- (Dr. Zhang: acupuncture is especially effective for urinary retention)

BL13-BL28 = Back-Shu series | treats ANY zang-fu organ directly from the back  
 Dr. Zhang: "Acupuncture is really good for the urination... just one point can treat it."

### High-Yield Points

| Pt   | Chinese      | Category                    | Key Indications                                               |
|------|--------------|-----------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| BL2  | Zanzhu       | Local eye point             | Eye redness/pain, frontal headache, wind dizziness            |
| BL10 | Tianzhu      | Neck region                 | Dizziness, occipital pain, neck rigidity, heavy head          |
| BL13 | Feishu       | Back-Shu of Lung            | Cough, asthma, chest fullness — treats Lung from the back     |
| BL23 | Shenshu      | Back-Shu of Kidney          | Low back pain, Kidney-deficiency patterns, tinnitus           |
| BL25 | Dachangshu   | Back-Shu of Large Intestine | Diarrhea, constipation, low back pain                         |
| BL28 | Pangguangshu | Back-Shu of Bladder         | Difficult urination, retention, enuresis                      |
| BL40 | Weizhong     | He-Sea + Command (back)     | Low back pain, stiffness of the spine; clears summer-heat     |
| BL57 | Chengshan    | Calf belly                  | Classic point for hemorrhoids; calf cramp/spasm               |
| BL60 | Kunlun       | Jing-River                  | "Aspirin of acupuncture" — headache, pain anywhere on pathway |
| BL62 | Shenmai      | Confluent — Yang Qiao Mai   | Insomnia (daytime type), epilepsy, lower-limb disorders       |
| BL67 | Zhiyin       | Jing-Well; last point       | Corrects fetal malposition with moxa; labor induction         |

### Five-Shu (Antique) Points - BL | Yang channel: Jing-Well = Metal

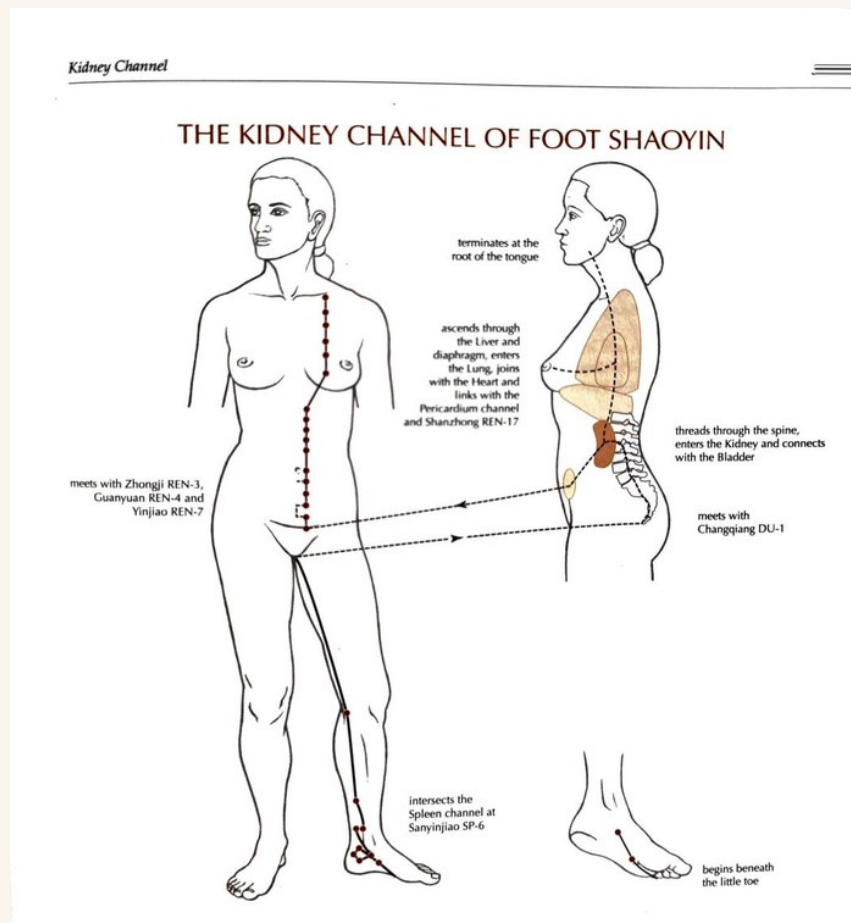
| Shu Point   | Element | Pt            | Clinical Use                                                     |
|-------------|---------|---------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Jing-Well   | Metal   | BL67 Zhiyin   | Loss of consciousness, epilepsy, mania; last-point resuscitation |
| Ying-Spring | Water   | BL66 Zutonggu | Headache, neck pain, epistaxis                                   |
| Shu-Stream  | Wood    | BL65 Shugu    | Headache, neck rigidity, mania                                   |
| Jing-River  | Fire    | BL60 Kunlun   | Headache/pain anywhere; difficult labor; "aspirin" point         |
| He-Sea      | Earth   | BL40 Weizhong | Low back pain, command point for the back; clears summer-heat    |

# The Kidney Meridian of Foot-Shaoyin

Yin | Water | 5 PM – 7 PM | 27 Points

Pertaining **Kidney**Connecting **Bladder**Back-Shu **BL23**Front-Mu **GB25 Jingmen**Yuan-Source **KI3**Luo **KI4**He-Sea **KI10**

## Internal Running Course



MOA - KI Meridian (internal pathway)

- 1 Starts beneath the small toe, runs obliquely to the sole of the foot (KI1 Yongquan).
- 2 Emerges below the tuberosity of the navicular bone (KI2 Rangu), curves behind the medial malleolus (KI3-KI8).
- 3 Enters the heel, ascends the medial calf to the medial side of the popliteal fossa (KI9, KI10 Yingu).
- 4 Continues up the postero-medial thigh toward the vertebral column, threading the spine, where it enters the Kidney (its pertaining organ) and connects with the Bladder.
- 5 STRAIGHT PORTION: re-emerges from the Kidney, ascends through the Liver and diaphragm, enters the Lung, runs along the throat, and terminates at the root of the tongue.
- 6 BRANCH: springs from the Lung, joins the Heart, and runs into the chest to link with the Pericardium Meridian of Hand-Jueyin – the channel that opens Week 6.
- 7 Internal course also passes through the lower abdomen and chest (KI11-KI27), crossing the Ren Mai at CV3, CV4, CV7 and CV17 along the way.

## Functions (MOA)

- Stores Essence (Jing); root of pre-natal/constitutional Qi
- Grasps Qi – anchors respiration; asthma when this fails
- Governs bone, marrow, and hearing
- ONLY channel reaching the tongue root via a re-emerging branch
- Front-Mu: GB25 Jingmen | Back-Shu: BL23 Shenshu

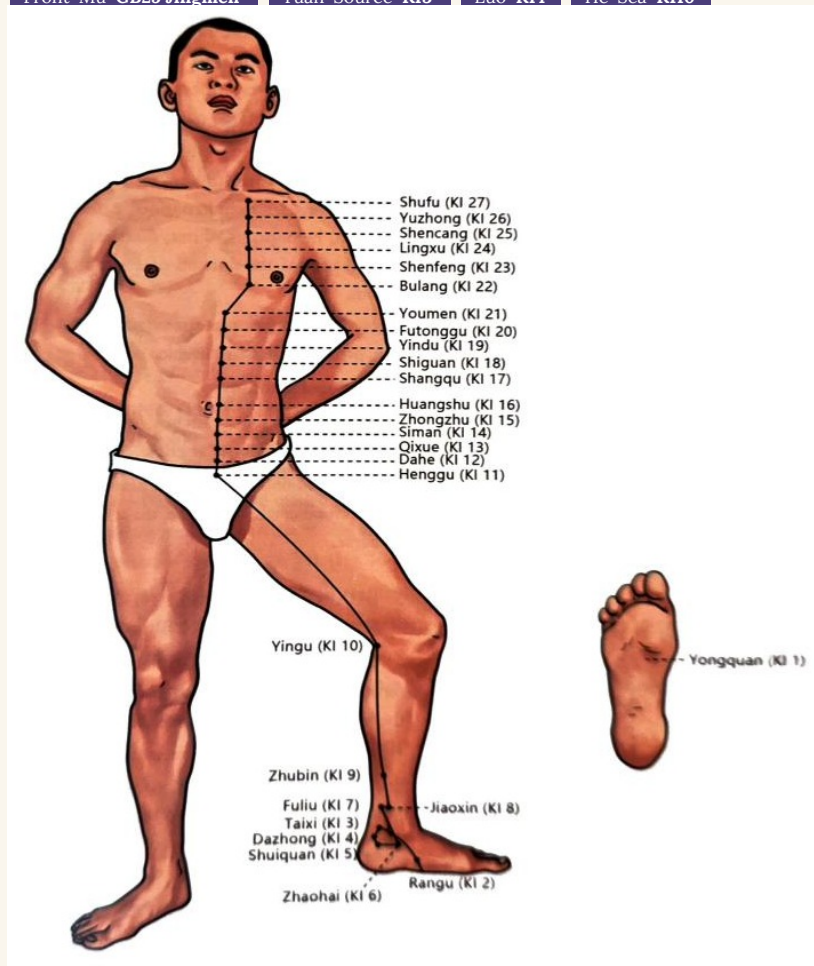


## The Kidney Meridian (KI) - External Running Course & CAM Figures

| Pertaining <b>Kidney</b> | Connecting <b>Bladder</b> | Back-Shu <b>BL23</b> | Front-Mu <b>GB25 Jingmen</b> | Yuan-Source <b>KI3</b> | Luo <b>KI4</b> | He-Sea <b>KI10</b> |
|--------------------------|---------------------------|----------------------|------------------------------|------------------------|----------------|--------------------|
|--------------------------|---------------------------|----------------------|------------------------------|------------------------|----------------|--------------------|

| Pt   | Chinese         | Location & Notes                                                                    |
|------|-----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| KI1  | <i>Yongquan</i> | Sole of foot, depression when plantar-flexed - Jing-Well; first point               |
| KI2  | Rangu           | Below tuberosity of navicular bone - Ying-Spring                                    |
| KI3  | <i>Taixi</i>    | Depression between medial malleolus tip & Achilles tendon - Shu-Stream; Yuan-Source |
| KI4  | <i>Dazhong</i>  | 0.5 cun posterior to KI3, medial calcaneus - Luo-connecting                         |
| KI5  | Shuiquan        | 1 cun below KI3, antero-superior to calcaneal tuberosity - Xi-Cleft                 |
| KI6  | <i>Zhaohai</i>  | 1 cun below tip of medial malleolus - Confluent - Yinqiao Mai                       |
| KI7  | <i>Fuliu</i>    | 2 cun above KI3, anterior to Achilles tendon - Jing-River                           |
| KI8  | Jiaoxin         | 2 cun above KI3, posterior to KI7 - Xi-Cleft of Yinqiao Mai                         |
| KI9  | Zhubin          | 5 cun above KI3, medial gastrocnemius head - Xi-Cleft of Yinwei Mai                 |
| KI10 | <i>Yingu</i>    | Medial end of popliteal crease - He-Sea                                             |
| KI11 | Henggu          | 5 cun below navel, 0.5 cun lateral to midline                                       |
| KI12 | Dahe            | 4 cun below navel, 0.5 cun lateral to midline                                       |
| KI13 | Qixue           | 3 cun below navel, 0.5 cun lateral to midline                                       |
| KI14 | Siman           | 2 cun below navel, 0.5 cun lateral to midline                                       |
| KI15 | Zhongzhu        | 1 cun below navel, 0.5 cun lateral to midline                                       |
| KI16 | <i>Huangshu</i> | Level with navel, 0.5 cun lateral to midline                                        |
| KI17 | Shangqu         | 2 cun above navel, 0.5 cun lateral to midline                                       |
| KI18 | Shiguan         | 3 cun above navel, 0.5 cun lateral to midline                                       |
| KI19 | Yindu           | 4 cun above navel, 0.5 cun lateral to midline                                       |
| KI20 | Futonggu        | 5 cun above navel, 0.5 cun lateral to midline                                       |
| KI21 | Youmen          | 6 cun above navel, 0.5 cun lateral to midline                                       |
| KI22 | Bulang          | 5th ICS, 2 cun lateral to midline                                                   |
| KI23 | Shenfeng        | 4th ICS, 2 cun lateral to midline                                                   |
| KI24 | Lingxu          | 3rd ICS, 2 cun lateral to midline                                                   |
| KI25 | Shencang        | 2nd ICS, 2 cun lateral to midline                                                   |
| KI26 | Yuzhong         | 1st ICS, 2 cun lateral to midline                                                   |
| KI27 | <i>Shufu</i>    | Inferior border of clavicle, 2 cun lateral to midline - Last point                  |



CAM Col. Fig. 9 - Kidney Meridian

## KI - Crossing Points & Syndromes (Compact)

Dr. Zhang: "KI's 6 crossing points are mostly in the abdomen and chest (SP6, GV1, CV3, CV4, CV7, CV17) – this is why KI is so powerful for abdominal, reproductive, and chest conditions."

### SP6 Sanyinjiao

SP6 / SP channel

Location: Medial leg, 3 cun above medial malleolus

#### Clinical:

KI's ascending pathway intersects the Spleen channel here – the same 3-Yin meeting point shared with SP and LR. Gynecological disorders, insomnia; FORBIDDEN IN PREGNANCY.

### GV1 Changqiang

GV1 / Du Mai

Location: Tip of coccyx

#### Clinical:

KI's internal course meets the Governor Vessel at its origin point near the coccyx as it threads the spine toward the Kidney. Hemorrhoids, prolapse, lower back/sacral pain.

### CV3 Zhongji

CV3 / Ren Mai

Location: Lower abdomen, 4 cun below navel

#### Clinical:

KI crosses the Ren Mai at CV3 – also the Front-Mu of the Bladder. Urinary retention, menstrual disorders, genital pain.

### CV4 Guanyuan

CV4 / Ren Mai

Location: Lower abdomen, 3 cun below navel

#### Clinical:

A major Qi-tonification gate that KI's internal pathway passes through. Chronic deficiency, infertility, menstrual regulation.

### CV7 Yinjiao

CV7 / Ren Mai

Location: Lower abdomen, 1 cun below navel

#### Clinical:

KI crosses the Ren Mai again at CV7 on its ascent through the abdomen. Abdominal pain, menstrual irregularity, umbilical discomfort.

### CV17 Shanzhong

CV17 / Ren Mai

Location: Chest, midline at nipple level

#### Clinical:

KI's ascending branch reaches the chest near CV17 (the Sea of Qi / Front-Mu of Pericardium) before linking with the Pericardium channel. Chest oppression, cough, breast disorders.

### A. External Course Symptoms

- Heel pain (Dr. Zhang's explicit clinical teaching point)
- Low back/knee weakness or pain along the medial leg
- Dry mouth, sore throat (pathway terminates at tongue root)
- Tongue-root numbness or stiffness (diagnostic sign)
- Cold sensation of soles, medial leg pain

### B. Internal Organ (Kidney)

- Essence (Jing) deficiency – developmental, reproductive, aging concerns
- Kidney fails to grasp Qi – asthma, shortness of breath on exertion
- Poor bone/marrow, weak knees and lower back
- Tinnitus, deafness, hair loss/graying
- Night sweats, five-palm heat (Yin deficiency pattern)
- Edema, poor water metabolism



## KI - High-Yield Points & Five-Shu

### High-Yield Points

| Pt   | Chinese  | Category                 | Key Indications                                                    |
|------|----------|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| KI1  | Yongquan | Jing-Well; first point   | Resuscitation, calms spirit; used in hypertension                  |
| KI3  | Taixi    | Shu-Stream + Yuan-Source | Key tonic point for Kidney Yin AND Yang                            |
| KI4  | Dazhong  | Luo-connecting           | Heel pain, weak lower back, apathy/low mood                        |
| KI6  | Zhaohai  | Confluent — Yinqiao Mai  | Insomnia, sore throat, irregular menstruation                      |
| KI7  | Fuliu    | Jing-River               | Tonifies Kidney Yang; edema; night sweats (pairs with HT6)         |
| KI10 | Yingu    | He-Sea                   | Difficult urination, impotence, medial knee pain                   |
| KI16 | Huangshu | Level with navel         | Abdominal pain, constipation/diarrhea; near-navel landmark         |
| KI27 | Shufu    | Last point               | Cough, asthma, chest oppression — links functionally to PC channel |

### Five-Shu (Antique) Points - KI | Yin channel: Jing-Well = Wood

| Shu Point   | Element | Pt           | Clinical Use                                            |
|-------------|---------|--------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| Jing-Well   | Wood    | KI1 Yongquan | Resuscitation, calms spirit, hypertension               |
| Ying-Spring | Fire    | KI2 Rangu    | Sore throat, spontaneous sweating, diabetes-type thirst |
| Shu-Stream  | Earth   | KI3 Taixi    | Yuan-source; master Kidney tonic, Yin AND Yang          |
| Jing-River  | Metal   | KI7 Fuliu    | Tonifies Kidney Yang; edema; night sweats               |
| He-Sea      | Water   | KI10 Yingu   | Difficult urination, impotence, medial knee pain        |

FORBIDDEN IN PREGNANCY (channels covered so far): SP6, LI4, BL60, BL67.

KI itself carries no individually forbidden point in the source material reviewed — flagged as not-yet-verified rather than assumed.

**Dr. Zhang's Clinical Pearls - Direct from Lecture***Highest exam probability***BL is the Longest Meridian in the Body (67 pts)**

The running course has FIVE branches, two crossing the head and three running the back. Dr. Zhang narrated the pathway video and had students draw every branch. Know all 5: (1) inner canthus->vertex, (2) branch to temple, (3) straight portion vertex->bladder, (4) lumbar branch->popliteal fossa, (5) largest branch, posterior neck->little toe.

**The Two Back Lines Run Simultaneously**

Dr. Zhang, direct Q&A: a student asked whether the back line travels down, back up, and down again, or runs both lines at the same time. Answer: 'at the same time.' Do not draw it as one line doubling back — this is a common student error.

**BL13-BL28: the Full Back-Shu Series**

Every one of the twelve zang-fu organs has a dedicated Back-Shu (transport) point on the BL channel — BL13 Lung through BL28 Bladder. This is why BL functions as a 'bridge' channel: any organ system can be treated directly from the back.

**BL60 Zusanli... no, Kunlun — the 'Aspirin of Acupuncture'**

Dr. Zhang's nickname for BL60: broad-spectrum pain relief — headache, pain anywhere along the pathway, difficult labor. Command point logic parallel to ST36's role on the Stomach channel.

**Heel Pain? Think Kidney First**

Verbatim clinical teaching point from lecture: the KI pathway curves directly behind the medial malleolus and through the heel. This is called out explicitly as the first channel to consider for heel pain in clinic.

**Only KI Connects to BOTH the Tongue Root and the Pericardium Channel**

KI's straight portion re-emerges from the Kidney, ascends through Liver and diaphragm into the Lung, and terminates at the tongue root. A separate branch off the Lung links to the Pericardium channel — setting up Week 6.

**BL & KI Pairing — Interior-Exterior Both Ways**

BL descends (head to foot), KI ascends (foot to chest) — the same descending/ascending dynamic seen in ST/SP. Urinary and low-back conditions can be approached from either channel depending on whether the external pathway or the internal organ pattern dominates.

**Posterior Circuit Complete: HT -> SI -> BL -> KI**

After Week 5, the entire Posterior (Inner) Circuit is covered. Dr. Zhang's own closing framing: 'until now, we have learned the posterior circuit, and four meridians consist of the posterior circuit.' HT (chest->hand) -> SI (hand->head) -> BL (head->foot) -> KI (foot->chest).

**BL Does NOT Connect to the Lung — Exam Trap**

BL's only internal connection is to the Kidney. Do not confuse this with the Metal-element pathway or any Lung-adjacent function — this is a confirmed midterm-era trap note worth re-checking before Quiz 4.

## Quiz 4 Fundamentals – Circuits & Nomenclature Review From Dr. Zhang's review slides

### Distribution of the 12 Main Meridians

#### ON THE LIMBS:

Medial aspect: YIN meridians

Lateral aspect: YANG meridians

Posterior: Shaoyin (yin) / Taiyang (yang) <- BL/KI here

#### ON THE HEAD & TRUNK:

Posterior: Taiyang (BL)

BL = Taiyang = most posterior on trunk

### Circulation of the 12 Meridians

c) Yang meridians of FOOT: head -> foot (BL)

d) Yin meridians of FOOT: foot -> chest (KI)

Qi flows one direction only – Dr. Zhang: 'it never goes back.'

This week completes the POSTERIOR circuit: HT -> SI -> BL -> KI

### Circuit Connections – EXACTLY what links to what (exam trap)

- HT (Heart) -> connects to SI via the little-finger branch -> ulnar side of little finger (SI1)
- SI (Small Intestine) -> connects to BL, via the inner/outer eye canthus crossing points
- BL (Bladder) -> connects to KI at the foot branch -> lateral tip of the little toe (KI1 origin)
- KI (Kidney) -> connects to PC (Pericardium), NOT Lung -> via an internal branch through the chest

Dr. Zhang stressed: BL connects to KIDNEY (not Lung), KI connects to PERICARDIUM (not Lung either) – both trap answers point students toward Lung incorrectly.

### Nomenclature

Meridian Name = 3 parts: (1) Hand or Foot, (2) Yin or Yang (Taiyin/Shaoyin/Jueyin, Yangming/Taiyang/Shaoyang), (3) Zang or Fu organ. e.g. "Bladder Meridian of Foot-Taiyang" / "Kidney Meridian of Foot-Shaoyin"

### Meridian Clock – BL & KI peak times

BL (Bladder): 3-5 PM | KI (Kidney): 5-7 PM | Preceded by: SI 1-3 PM | Followed by: PC 7-9 PM

Full order: LU LI ST SP HT SI BL KI PC SJ GB LR – 24-hr cycle, 2 hrs each, Qi flows in sequence

*Dr. Zhang's homework rule: DRAW BOTH internal AND external pathways for every meridian.  
"Some students only draw external – the internal pathway is also important."*

## BL vs KI - Quick Reference Comparison

| Attribute       | BL   Bladder (Foot Taiyang)           | KI   Kidney (Foot Shaoyin)                            |
|-----------------|---------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| Yin / Yang      | Yang (posterior)                      | Yin (posterior/medial)                                |
| Element         | Water                                 | Water                                                 |
| Circuit         | Posterior — Head to Foot              | Posterior — Foot to Chest                             |
| Clock           | 3–5 PM                                | 5–7 PM                                                |
| Points          | 67 (BL1–BL67)                         | 27 (KI1–KI27)                                         |
| Start           | BL1 Jingming (inner canthus)          | KI1 Yongquan (sole of foot)                           |
| End             | BL67 Zhiyin (lateral little toe)      | KI27 Shufu (below clavicle)                           |
| Branches        | 5 branches total                      | 3 branches total                                      |
| Pertaining      | Bladder                               | Kidney                                                |
| Connecting      | Kidney                                | Bladder                                               |
| Back-Shu        | BL28 (of itself)                      | BL23                                                  |
| Front-Mu        | CV3 Zhongji                           | GB25 Jingmen                                          |
| Yuan-Source     | BL64 Jinggu                           | KI3 Taixi                                             |
| Luo             | BL58 Feiyang                          | KI4 Dazhong                                           |
| Xi-Cleft        | BL63 Jinmen                           | KI5 Shuiquan                                          |
| He-Sea          | BL40 Weizhong                         | KI10 Yingu                                            |
| Confluent Pt    | BL62 (opens Yang Qiao Mai)            | KI6 (opens Yin Qiao Mai)                              |
| Command Pt      | BL40 (Back)                           | —                                                     |
| Crossing Pts    | 14 (mostly head/back — GV & GB)       | 6 (mostly abdomen/chest — SP, GV, CV)                 |
| Unique Feature  | Longest channel; full Back-Shu series | Only channel to root of tongue via re-emerging branch |
| Ext Symptoms    | Headache, neck/back/leg pain          | Heel pain, dry mouth, sore throat                     |
| Int Symptoms    | Urinary retention, dysuria            | Essence deficiency, asthma, bone/marrow weakness      |
| Qi Direction    | Descends (head to foot)               | Ascends (foot to chest)                               |
| Forbidden Preg. | BL60, BL67                            | —                                                     |